THE STARTUP FOUNDER WHO WANTED AN MBA: PRESENTING ENTREPRENEURIAL EXPERIENCE EFFECTIVELY

CASE STUDY STRATEGY WORKSHEET: IRA KHANNA | CAREER TRANSITIONS & NON-TRADITIONAL

1. Student Persona & Challenge Diagnostic Audit

Candidate: Ira Khanna | Profile: Startup founder, 4 years of experience.. This worksheet outlines the systematic forensic diagnostic and strategic intervention designed to resolve this admissions roadblock.

Assessment Dimension	Diagnostic Finding & Initial Challenge	Strategic Objective
Candidate Profile	Startup founder, 4 years of experience.	Build differentiated application proposition
Core Admissions Roadblock	Ira had founded a small venture and learned through difficult business decisions. However, she was uncertain about how to present a business...	Eliminate systemic bottlenecks through data feedback
Root Cause Identified	Misalignment between effort and strategic execution	Shift from generic repetition to targeted intervention
Admissions Target	Competitive Global / Indian MBA Program	Maximize admit ROI and scholarship potential

Key Diagnostic Insight:

"A high test score or strong resume alone is not a substitute for a coherent admissions story. Every applicant requires a personalized roadmap that aligns quantitative readiness with distinctive leadership impact." — Mr. Surinder Gupta (IIT Roorkee)

2. Step-by-Step Strategic Intervention

- Reviewed the startup's actual development.
- Identified business decisions and personal contributions.
- Examined customer, operational and financial evidence.
- Documented setbacks and lessons.
- Clarified future career ambitions.

3. Actionable Checklist for MBA Applicants

- Diagnostic First: Never increase preparation hours or rewrite essays without an objective diagnostic baseline.
- Data-Driven Tracking: Use targeted analytics to monitor error patterns rather than counting raw study hours.
- Holistic Narrative: Connect undergraduate background, career progression, and MBA goals into one cohesive arc.
- Expert Perspective: Involve senior mentors early to eliminate blind spots and stress-test interview responses.
- Advice: A preparation strategy must fit your reality. Consistency always beats sporadic marathons.

A founder considering an MBA? Get your entrepreneurial experience evaluated.

Schedule a 1-on-1 strategy session with Mr. Surinder Gupta (IIT Roorkee) at www.mbawizards.co.in